

World War II: The Home Front

Trace how World War II reshaped the American home front across four systems — political, economic, social-cultural, and geographic — and weigh who benefited and who bore the costs.

? Historical challenge

World War II was fought overseas, but it transformed life inside the United States. The war remade American politics, the economy, society and culture, and where people lived — and it did so unevenly. Follow the war's shockwaves outward through four systems, weigh who benefited and who bore the costs, and decide which change left the deepest mark.

1 Investigate

SOURCES 1

Executive Order 9066 (1942) – National Archives

PRIMARY SOURCE

The order that led to the forced removal and incarceration of Japanese Americans.

[Open source ↗](#)

Investigate:

- What did EO 9066 authorize?
- Who bore the costs of this policy?

SOURCES 2

The Home Front by the Numbers – The National WWII Museum

SECONDARY SOURCE

War production, rationing, and workforce statistics for the home front.

[Open source ↗](#)

Investigate:

- How did the U.S. economy change during the war?
- What evidence shows the scale of mobilization?

SOURCES 3

Rosie the Riveter: Working Women and World War II – Library of Congress

SECONDARY SOURCE

How women's wartime work changed the workforce and its image.

[Open source ↗](#)

Investigate:

- How did women's roles change during the war?
- What happened to those opportunities after 1945?

2 Build your Event Map

Fill in the organizer from the evidence. Mark information with ①②③ to show which source it came from. Leave a space blank if the sources don't tell you.

THE EVENT

The U.S. Home Front in World War II

1941–1945

The United States

Political

IMMEDIATE EFFECT

.....

SECONDARY EFFECT

.....

EVIDENCE

.....

Economic

IMMEDIATE EFFECT

.....

SECONDARY EFFECT

.....

EVIDENCE

.....

Social / cultural

IMMEDIATE EFFECT

.....

SECONDARY EFFECT

.....

EVIDENCE

.....

Geographic / environmental

IMMEDIATE EFFECT

.....

SECONDARY EFFECT

.....

EVIDENCE

.....

Who benefited?

.....

Who bore the costs?

.....

Which effect had the greatest significance? Explain with evidence.

.....

Sources 1

Sources 2

Sources 3

3 Compare

- Compare your four pathways with a partner. Did you find the same immediate and secondary effects?
- Did you rank the same effect as most lasting? Defend your ranking with evidence.

4 Expand

Your teacher will add context, vocabulary, and information the sources leave out. Add it to your map.

5 Revise

Go back to your Event Map. Add, correct, or reorganize based on the discussion.

6 Conclude

Which home-front effect mattered most in shaping the United States? Support your ranking with specific evidence from at least two pathways and two sources, and address who benefited and who bore the costs.